

CONTENDER AMERICA

Elizabeth Langworthy Lord
109 Asteria Street
Greenville, SC 29617
Via Hand Delivery

November 24, 2025

RE: Notice of Claims dated November 14, 2025 and Related Materials (the "Notice")

Dear Beth:

This letter will serve as the response of Contender Development, Inc. and the other entities you mentioned in the Notice (collectively, the "Company"). For the reasons that follow, the Company denies that any of your claims are actionable and respectfully declines your offer of a severance package.

The vast majority of the complaints set forth in the Notice are duplicative of concerns you have previously expressed. The Company has addressed them in an appropriate fashion as part of the ongoing interactive process between you and the Company.

While I will not attempt to refute every detail set forth in your Notice, I would like to take this opportunity to respond to your allegations of age-based comments:

You allege Peter Reinert made a comment expressing age animus during a meeting on or about April 25, 2025. Mr. Reinert denies making any such comment. I was present in that meeting and have no recollection of any such comment.

You allege over-hearing a conversation between Connor Parsons and Adam Plous regarding an older employee. Mr. Plous was not part of that conversation. Instead, it was between Mr. Parsons and myself where we were recounting our days in the hotel business and our preference for hiring older employees due to their skills and dependability. When I followed up with you later, you indicated that was not the conversation you were referring to, but you could not offer any additional details other than Messrs. Plous and Parsons were alleged to be discussing an employee at the Company's North Charleston Element hotel; neither gentlemen has any recollection of such a conversation.

You allege that Haley Cape shared your age with other co-workers. Ms. Cape denies that occurred and stated she does not know your age.

Last, your preservation request is acknowledged. The Company will adhere to its obligations under the law.

You obviously feel strongly that you have been treated unfairly by the Company and it is regrettable that you feel that way. However, the Company denies in the strongest possible terms that you have been discriminated against and respectfully submits that it has addressed your grievances and concerns in a timely and appropriate manner.

We very much hope you keep working at the Company. For that reason, we have no interest in engaging in discussions concerning a severance package as you have suggested.

My door is always open should you desire to discuss this letter or anything else for that matter.

Sincerely,

Cameron Aldridge
Human Resources Director

Cameron Aldridge